Tomer Tarragano

BSc Chemistry (Hons), University of Birmingham · Master's graduate from the University of North Carolina Chapel Hill

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PROFILE

Master's graduate of the University of North Carolina Chapel Hill and chemistry graduate from the University of Birmingham with extensive wet-lab experience across synthetic, analytical and physical chemistry, and a final-year research paper graded top of cohort. Outside academics, a GB international distance runner — accustomed to performing at a high standard under pressure and over long time horizons.

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill — MSc, Applied Professional Studies Aug 2025 – Jun 2026

Concentration: Data analytics, sports doping and health policy

- Capstone: a policy brief, education package and capability-gap mapping tool for the World Anti-Doping Agency and under-resourced national anti-doping organisations.

University of Birmingham — BSc Chemistry (Hons) Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

Royal Society of Chemistry accredited programme

- Core modules across inorganic, organic, physical and analytical chemistry; Structural Analysis; Practical Chemistry I & II (200+ hours of taught lab work, plus the research project).
- Final-year research project graded top of cohort for the literature review component (see below).

Laboratory skills & techniques

- Synthetic chemistry — inorganic and organic prep
- Spectroscopic characterisation (NMR, IR, UV-Vis, MS)
- Lab notebook keeping & technical report writing
- Data analysis & graph-plotting software
- Separation & purification (distillation, recrystallisation, chromatography - TLC and column)
- Quantitative analysis & error treatment
- Lab safety, COSHH and risk assessment
- Information retrieval & scientific literature review
- Working independently and within small research groups
- Operating, calibrating and troubleshooting bench instrumentation

FINAL-YEAR RESEARCH PROJECT

Analytical Chemistry of the Detection of Sports Doping University of Birmingham · Mar 2025

Supervisor: Dr Ruchi Gupta · Awarded top grade in cohort for literature review

- Critical review of analytical techniques (IEF, LC-MS, flow cytometry, immunoassays) used in elite anti-doping, with deep focus on blood doping detection and the Athlete Biological Passport.
- Evaluated emerging point-of-care testing (POCT) approaches — including aptamer / gold-nanoparticle sensors and dried-blood-spot sampling — and their integration with metabolomics and AI-led longitudinal monitoring.
- Required sustained independent literature retrieval, synthesis of conflicting evidence, and clear technical writing for an examining audience.

WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Birmingham — Senior Casting Technician Jul 2026 – Present · Birmingham

Department of Metallurgy and Materials

- Operate foundry and met-prep facilities, including the Retech vacuum furnace (vacuum and melting operations; equipment maintenance) plus cutting, grinding and polishing; work to departmental health and safety requirements.
- Support PhD researchers, academic staff and other facility users across foundry, characterisation and battery-lab work; trained on relevant apparatus and methods including sonication.

Edgbaston Golf Club — Bartender Jul 2022 – Jul 2023 · Birmingham

- Owned stock control and restocking across a high-throughput member bar; routine procurement and inventory checks.
- Maintained cleanliness, hygiene and licensing standards through busy member events and private functions.

Birmingham 2022 Commonwealth Games — F&B Assistant Jul 2022 – Aug 2022 · Birmingham

- Supported high-volume, time-critical operations across athlete, staff and spectator zones; worked to documented hygiene and safety standards under audit.

Brighton College Prep School — Teaching Assistant Sep 2019 – Jun 2020 · Brighton

- Full-time keyworker during 2020 lockdown; covered teaching, sport and pastoral cover, requiring clear communication and reliable day-to-day organisation.

PERSONAL — ATHLETICS

Great Britain international distance runner; cross country/track; **#21 5000m** globally indoors 2026.

- **2024 European Cross Country Championships, Antalya** — Team bronze medallist, representing GB & NI.
- Winner, **British Team European XC Trials** (Liverpool, 2024); selected for GB U23 squad in 2022 and 2023.
- **British Universities & Colleges Sport (BUCS) Champion** — 10,000m (2023) and Cross Country (2025).
- Student-athlete scholar at **the University of North Carolina Chapel Hill**.
- NCAA DI Cross Country USTFCCCA **All-Academic Athlete**, 3x All-ACC, All-American 10,000m (2026)

1500 M	3000 M	5000 M	10,000 M
3:39.84	7:47.32	13:27.37	28:34.74

TECHNICAL & COMPUTER SKILLS

- Microsoft Office — Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook
- Python for data analysis (pandas, matplotlib, seaborn)
- Scientific writing — APA / Vancouver / Harvard referencing
- JMP Pro, R, Stata, SPSS statistical software
- Cursor AI / code; general scientific computing
- Comfortable picking up internal systems

REFERENCES

Available on request.